



BUILDING DEPARTMENT EARLY START PERMITTING GUIDELINES

Purpose

The City of Doral Building Department has implemented an Early Start Permitting Program so that residents and businesses can commence construction work sooner. Early Start Permitting allows applicants to begin limited work while the permit application for permit is finishing review. Using a qualified contractor to start preliminary work while the permit documents are in process provides customers with a head start on their project timeline.

Authority

Section 105 of the **Florida Building Code** allows limited work to start before a permit is issued. The FBC allows certain work to commence up to the point when an inspection would be required. A contractor MAY NOT continue work beyond the point of a required inspection without an official permit.

Process

Applicant may request an Early Start Permit prior to completing the review process. The applicant **MUST** have a licensed contractor to perform the work outlined by the Early Start Permit. Zoning approval and County/Outside Agency reviews shall be complete. Administrative Coordinator will schedule a pre-construction meeting with the Building Official and a fee is due prior to issuance of the Early Start Approval.

Procedure

1. Submit **Early Start Permitting Application** and **Pre-Construction Meeting Checklist** while proactively completing review rounds with city and outside agencies. Please allow 1-2 business days for processing.
2. Ensure all upfront permit fees and Early Start fees are paid.
3. Ensure Zoning Approval is complete and outside agency reviews complete.
4. Attend Pre-construction meeting with Building Official, Applicant/Owner AND Contractor.
5. Issue Early Start Permit Approval and post the Early Start Permit Card in a conspicuous location on job site (typically at regular construction signage and address) and proceed with limited work.
6. Contractor must file a Notice of Commencement (NOC) as per F.S. 713 prior to any work being completed and posted at job site prior to first inspection.
7. Continue to proactively resolve outstanding comments to obtain standard building permit.
8. **CAUTION: Work that extends beyond the scope of the approval, is concealed or is unable to be inspected, will be charged a Work Without Permit Fee and Fine.**
9. **Inspections CANNOT be obtained on any work until the official building permit has been issued.**
10. **Once work has commenced under an Early Start Permit, the regular building permit submittal may NOT be cancelled.**
11. **DO NOT conceal any work performed.**
12. **DO NOT allow the permit process number to expire.**



**BUILDING DEPARTMENT
EARLY START PERMITTING APPLICATION**

Owner/Tenant Name: _____ Permit Number: _____

Job Address: _____ Suite #: _____

Description of Work: _____

	Qualifier and Company Name**	License Number
Building:	_____	_____
Electrical:	_____	_____
Mechanical:	_____	_____
Plumbing:	_____	_____

In accordance with the **Florida Building Code** Section 105, construction work is hereby authorized to commence pursuant to this permit at the above referenced address. **Work done pursuant to this permit shall not be concealed but shall remain open for inspection.** Work can only proceed up to the point an inspection is required. Applicant is responsible for knowing when inspections are required and may not rely upon representation of the City or its employees for such information. An inspection shall not be made for any construction trade until a building permit has been issued for the project. The use of a special inspector is not authorized for this type of permit. Issuance of this permit does not constitute permission to violate the building code and does not provide any guarantee that construction plans will be approved as submitted. All work done pursuant to this permit shall be at the contractor's risk and any work done contrary to the approved permit shall be corrected at the contractor's expense. The City of Doral shall not be held liable for any damages or losses resulting from this work.

Failure to comply with any of the foregoing conditions shall constitute a violation of the Florida Building Code.

*Fee paid for Early Start Permit is **not refundable**, is not part of the upfront fee, and is not applied towards regular permit fees.

**All contractors must be registered with the City of Doral Building Department and submit current Worker's Comp and Liability Insurance with Early Start application.

X _____
Signature of Owner/Tenant

X _____
Signature of Building Qualifier

PRINT NAME OF OWNER/TENANT _____
STATE OF FLORIDA, COUNTY OF _____

PRINT NAME OF QUALIFIER _____
STATE OF FLORIDA, COUNTY OF _____

Sworn to (or affirmed) and subscribed before me this _____
day of _____ 20____,

Sworn to (or affirmed) and subscribed before me this _____
day of _____ 20____,

by (Print Name) _____

by (Print Name) _____

Notary Name _____

Notary Name _____

Personally known ☐ or I.D. _____

Personally known ☐ or I.D. _____

FOR OFFICE USE ONLY

Zoning Clearance: ☐ Approved ☐ Denied by: _____ Date: _____

Meeting Date: _____ E.S. Fee Paid*: \$ _____ Date: _____ County/AHJ Approval _____

Building Official Approval: _____ Date: _____

Conditions: _____

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BUILDING DEPARTMENT EARLY START PRE-CONSTRUCTION MEETING CHECKLIST

The Early Start Program is a special permit that is designed to allow limited work to commence before the issuance of a building permit. While the building permit application and plans are being reviewed, the contractor may begin preliminary work up to the point an inspection is required. Inspections cannot be obtained under this program; moreover, the preparatory work must stop once an inspection requirement is reached, unless the building permit has already been issued. This interview will explain the conditions and limitations of the Early Start Program. You will be advised of the consequences of not complying with these conditions and have an opportunity to ask questions.

1. Name of owner/tenant: _____
2. Phone #: _____ Email: _____
3. Name of Qualifier: _____
4. Phone #: _____ Email: _____
5. Project Address: _____ Process Number: _____
6. Business operations cannot commence without an occupational license.
7. The contractor cannot disconnect any life safety systems or connect any new electrical, plumbing or mechanical systems.
8. Inspections of any type cannot be obtained or issued including all required and courtesy inspections.
9. The contractor cannot use the Architect, Engineer, or any third party firm for inspection purposes.
10. **Work may not be concealed.** Any work that is concealed will be required to be removed for inspection once a permit is issued.
11. If the point is reached where an inspection is required and the building permit is not issued, **the work must cease.**
12. The process number that is issued to the regular permit application cannot be allowed to expire. The initial duration is six (6) months with ninety (90) day extensions upon written request.
13. If the building permit cannot be approved and issued, this permit shall be revoked, and any work that has commenced must be removed under a separate demolition permit with all costs of demolition and permits to be paid by applicant.
14. If the permit application cannot be approved as submitted, any work that was installed must be modified or removed at the owner/tenant or contractor's sole expense. The City shall not be held liable for any damages or losses resulting from this work.
15. Must post a copy of Early Start Permit in a conspicuous place on the job site.
16. The consequences for not complying with the aforementioned guidelines will result in revocation of this permit and an issuance of a Notice of Violation and declaring the premises unsafe. Proceeding beyond the scope of this special permit will be considered a violation and will be processed to the full extent of the law. In addition, owner/tenant and/or contractor and sub-contractors will not be allowed to participate in this program in the future.
17. This permit shall not create any vested rights, nor shall it serve as a basis to prevent enforcement of the building codes. This permit shall not be relied upon by the applicant as evidence that the contemplated improvements that are the subject of the building permit are permitted or meet applicable codes.
18. In the event the City is compelled to enforce the terms of this permit, applicant shall be responsible for the City's cost of enforcement including, without limitation, attorney's fees and costs in the event the City prevails.

I (We) the undersigned hereby understand the above conditions as read and/or explained to me (us). I (We) agree to abide by these conditions and will not violate the intent of the Building Code or the Early Start Program. I (We) furthermore hold the City and its staff harmless and not liable for any damages or losses resulting from this program.

X

Signature of Owner/Tenant

PRINT OWNER NAME _____

STATE OF FLORIDA, COUNTY OF _____

Sworn to (or affirmed) and subscribed before me this _____
day of _____ 20____,

by (Print Name) _____

Notary Name _____

Personally known ☐ or I.D. _____

X

Signature of Building Qualifier

PRINT QUALIFIER NAME _____

STATE OF FLORIDA, COUNTY OF _____

Sworn to (or affirmed) and subscribed before me this _____
day of _____ 20____,

by (Print Name) _____

Notary Name _____

Personally known ☐ or I.D. _____

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